

HiFRAP installation and use instructions

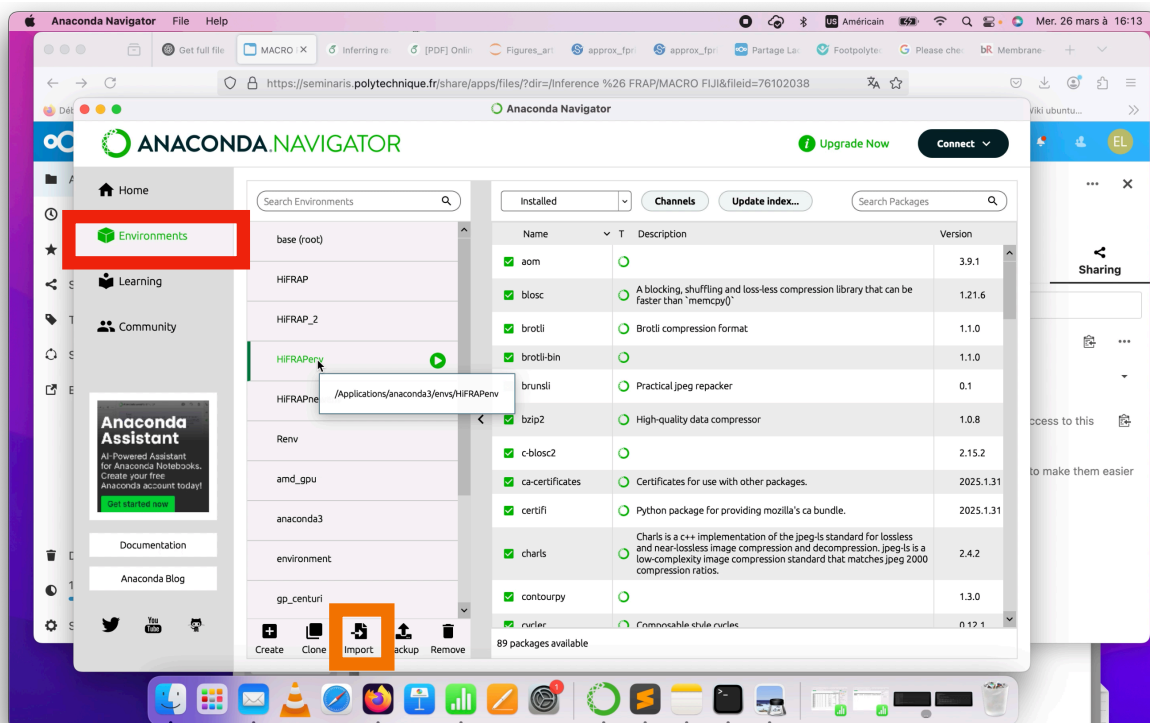
1. Download HiFRAP

1. Download the latest version of HiFRAP (e.g. HiFRAP_v001).
2. Unzip the downloaded file and ensure that the folder contains a folder named **HiFRAP**.

2. Install HiFRAP environment using Anaconda

1. Open **Anaconda Navigator**. If you have not installed it on your computer, go to <https://www.anaconda.com/products/distribution> and download the appropriate version for your operating system.
2. Go to **Environments** (left sidebar), as indicated by the red box in Figure 1.
3. Click **Import** in the bottom bar, as indicated by the orange box in Figure 1.
4. In the file dialog box, navigate to the **HiFRAP** folder that you have extracted earlier and go to the **env** folder. Select the **HiFRAPenv.yaml** file to import it.
5. Wait for the installation to complete (this may take several minutes).

Figure 1



6. Once the HiFRAP environment is installed, **visualise its path** in Anaconda Navigator by moving the cursor on the HiFRAPenv bar as shown in Figure 1 (typical path: Applications/Anaconda3/HiFRAP_env). Alternatively, click on the arrow in the green circle and select 'Open Terminal'. The path appears after 'conda activate' in the command that is executed.
7. **Keep a note** of this path for later use.
8. You may close the Anaconda Navigator; it will not be used anymore by HiFRAP.

2. Install HiFRAP in Fiji

Step 1: Copy HiFRAP to the Fiji plugins folder

1. Navigate to the extracted **HiFRAP** folder.
2. Copy the entire **HiFRAP** folder.
3. Locate your **Fiji** installation directory.
4. Open the **plugins** folder within Fiji (with Fiji closed).
5. Paste the **HiFRAP** folder inside the **plugins** directory.

Step 2: Launch Fiji and load HiFRAP

1. Open **Fiji**.
2. Load an image file for analysis. Two sample .tiff file (1D and 2D FRAP experiments) are included in the **Examples** folder inside **HiFRAP** folder.
3. Locate and select **HiFRAP** from the list of **Plugins** in the Fiji toolbar. If HiFRAP does not appear, verify that the folder was correctly placed in the **plugins** directory or run install plugin in the plugins bar.

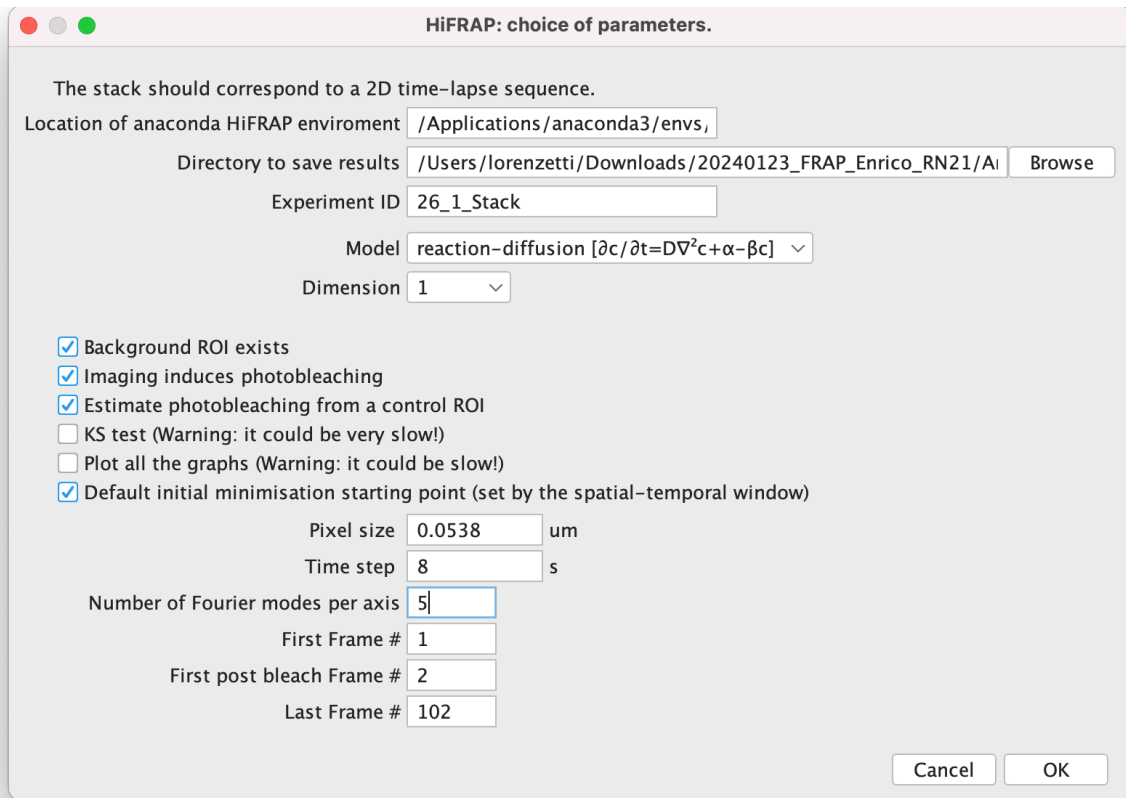
3. Run HiFRAP analysis

Step 1: Input parameters

Once HiFRAP is launched, a dialog box prompts you for the input parameters (Figure 2A):

1. **HiFRAP environment path:** Enter the Anaconda environment path noted earlier.
2. **Output directory:** Choose where you want to save results.
3. **Experiment name:** Assign a label to your analysis. Do not use spaces in the name (use underscores _ instead).

Figure 2A



HiFRAP: choice of parameters.

The stack should correspond to a 2D time-lapse sequence.

Location of anaconda HiFRAP environment: /Applications/anaconda3/envs, /

Directory to save results: /Users/lorenzetti/Downloads/20240123_FRAP_Enrico_RN21/A/ Browse

Experiment ID: 26_1_Stack

Model: reaction-diffusion [$\partial c / \partial t = D \nabla^2 c + \alpha - \beta c$] ▾

Dimension: 1 ▾

☒ Background ROI exists

☒ Imaging induces photobleaching

☒ Estimate photobleaching from a control ROI

☐ KS test (Warning: it could be very slow!)

☐ Plot all the graphs (Warning: it could be slow!)

☒ Default initial minimisation starting point (set by the spatial-temporal window)

Pixel size: 0.0538 um

Time step: 8 s

Number of Fourier modes per axis: 5

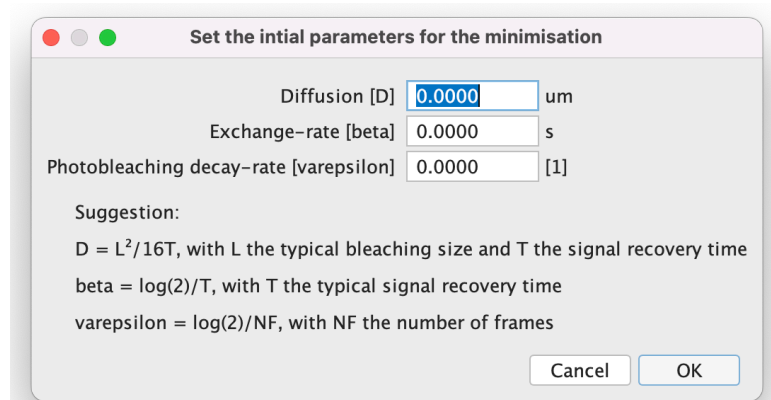
First Frame #: 1

First post bleach Frame #: 2

Last Frame #: 102

Cancel OK

Figure 2B



Set the initial parameters for the minimisation

Diffusion [D]: 0.0000 um

Exchange-rate [beta]: 0.0000 s

Photobleaching decay-rate [varepsilon]: 0.0000 [1]

Suggestion:

$D = L^2 / 16T$, with L the typical bleaching size and T the signal recovery time

$\beta = \log(2) / T$, with T the typical signal recovery time

$\text{varepsilon} = \log(2) / NF$, with NF the number of frames

Cancel OK

4. Select model type:

- Diffusion, described by the partial differential equation (PDE) $\partial_t c = D \nabla^2 c$.
- Reaction-diffusion, described by the PDE $\partial_t c = D \nabla^2 c + \alpha - \beta c$.
- Reaction, described by the PDE $\partial_t c = \alpha - \beta c$.

5. Dimension:

- 1D for FRAP experiments on a (possibly curved) line.

- 2D for FRAP experiments on a flat surface.
6. **Image processing settings:**
 - **Background ROI exists:** Tick the checkbox if a background (sample-free) area is available.
 - **Imaging-induces photobleaching:** Tick the checkbox if imaging induces gradual photobleaching.
 - **Estimate photobleaching from a control ROI:** Tick the checkbox if applicable.
 6. **KS test:**
 - Tick the checkbox to also evaluate fit quality with the Kolmogorov-Smirnov test. This test is very slow.
 7. **Plot all the graphs:**
 - Tick the checkbox to generate plots of curve fits and cost function. This may slow down computation.
 8. **Default initial minimisation starting point:**
 - Tick the checkbox to use the default values of initial parameters for diffusion and/or exchange-rate and/or photobleaching decay-rate based on the spatial-temporal window of the analysed time-lapse video. If not, you may insert these values manually as in figure 2B.
 8. **Pixel size and time step:**
 - Input a specific value (e.g., 0.00538) for the pixel size and time step (e.g., 8) .
 9. **Frame selection:**
 - First frame, including photobleaching frame, to analyse (e.g 1).
 - First post-bleaching frame (e.g 2).
 - Last frame to analyse.
 10. **Fourier modes:**
 - Use an **odd integer (e.g., 5, 7, 9)**. Start with **5** for fast computation.

Step 2: Select Regions of Interest (ROI)

In 2D:

1. Select a **sample-free area** for **background estimation** as in figure 3A (appears only if corresponding checkbox ticked earlier).
2. **Select a control area** that has not been FRAPped to estimate photobleaching during imaging as in Figure 3B (appears only if corresponding checkbox ticked earlier).

3. Select the **FRAPped region and its surroundings** as in Figure 3C.

Figure 3A: Background

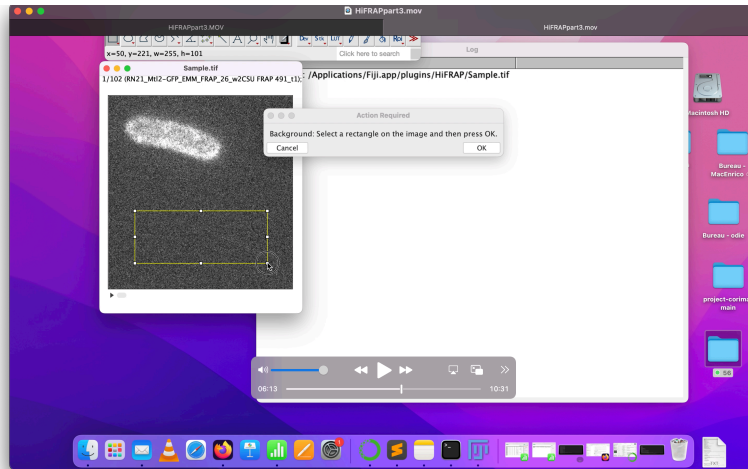


Figure 3B: Control area

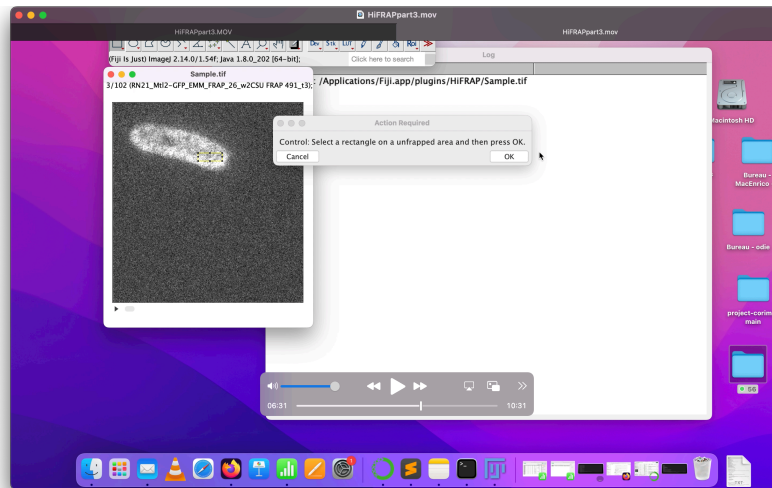
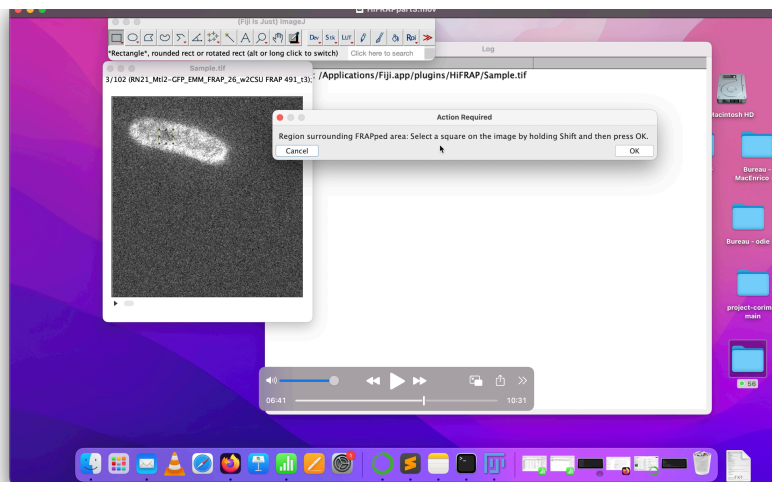


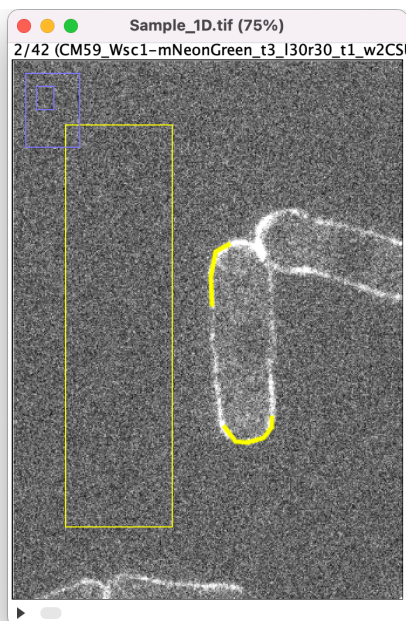
Figure 3C: FRAP ROI



In 1D:

Analogous to 2D case except that you need to select polylines (of thickness to be specified) instead of rectangles/squares for the FRAP and control ROIs, as shown in Figure 3D.

Figure 3D: 1D ROIs



Step 3: Run Analysis

1. Click on Ok to run the Analysis.
2. Wait for the analysis to be finished (several seconds).

Step 4: Visualise the results

1. If successful, the program will generate various plots (provided you ticked the corresponding checkbox):
 - **Cost Function Plot (Linear & Log Scale):** Ensure the minima is well centred.
 - **Fit of Time-lapse Video.** In 2D the best fit is plotted for 4 frames occurring at 0, $T/3$, $2T/3$ and T with T the total duration of the video from the initial postbleach frame. In 1D the best fit is represented with a kymograph (space vs time).
2. Close the plots to complete the analysis. These plots are automatically saved in the output folder with a name based on the experiment name and model used for analysis. Ex: Experiment_1_diff_data_fit.pdf
3. Next, all the results can be found in:
 - **Fiji Log File** (Viewable within Fiji).

- **Results.csv** file in the output directory.

Full output description

1. Experiment name

The name assigned to the experiment. By default: the last two directories of the image path + model + .tiff title.

2. Dimension

Indicates whether the experiment was done in 1D or 2D.

3. Model

Type of model used: "diff" (diffusion only), "reac-diff" (reaction-diffusion), or "reac" (reaction only).

4. Background

Indicates whether a background ROI (Region of Interest) was defined: 1 = yes, 0 = no.

5. Control

Indicates whether a control ROI was defined: 1 = yes, 0 = no.

6. Photobleaching

If 1, photobleaching during acquisition was considered to be significant. 0 otherwise.

7. Time step - Δt

Time between two image frames (in seconds).

8. Pixel size - Δx

Size of one pixel in micrometers (μm).

9. First Frame

Frame number where analysis begins, includes pre-bleach frames.

10. Postbleach frame

Number of the frame that follows FRAPping.

11. Last frame

Frame number where the analysis ends.

12. Number of pixels per frame - n_x

Total number of pixels analysed per frame per axis.

13. Background coordinates

Coordinates of the background ROI in the format: (x_min, y_min, x_max, y_max).

14. Control coordinates

Coordinates of the control ROI: (x_min, y_min, x_max, y_max) — for 2D analysis.

15. ROI coordinates

Coordinates of the bleached (FRAP) ROI: (x_min, y_min, x_max, y_max) — for 2D analysis.

16. **Polyline ctrl [x,y]**
X and Y coordinates of the control ROI drawn with a polyline — for 1D analysis.
17. **Polyline frap [x,y]**
X and Y coordinates of the bleached ROI drawn with a polyline — for 1D analysis.
18. **Line thickness**
Thickness of the polylines — for 1D analysis.
19. **nqc - n_q**
Number of Fourier modes per axis used for compression.
20. **D_in - D_{in}**
Initial guess for the diffusion coefficient for the cost minimisation.
21. **beta_in - β_{in}**
Initial guess for the exchange-rate for the cost minimisation.
22. **varepsilon_in - ϵ_{in}**
Initial guess for the photobleaching decay-rate for the cost minimisation.
23. **D_est - D_{est}**
Estimated diffusion coefficient.
24. **err_D - σ_D**
Error associated with the estimated diffusion coefficient.
25. **alpha_est - α_{est}**
Estimated alpha parameter (typically associated with reaction rate) in the A.U. of the signal.
26. **err_alpha - σ_α**
Error on the estimated alpha value in the A.U. of the signal.
27. **beta_est - β_{est}**
Estimated exchange rate (or dissociation rate) in seconds.
28. **err_beta - σ_β**
Error on the estimated beta value in seconds.
29. **varepsilon - ϵ**
Estimated photobleaching correction factor.
30. **err_varepsilon - σ_ϵ**
Error on the estimated photobleaching factor.
31. **bg_est - I_{est}^{BG}**
Estimated background intensity from model fitting (A.U.).
32. **err_bg - $\sigma_{I_{BG}}$**
Error on the estimated background (A.U.).
33. **R^2_adj - R_{adj}^2**
Value of the adjusted coefficient of determination indicating the quality of the fit.

- 34. kol_pvalue**
P-value from the Kolmogorov-Smirnov test to evaluate the goodness of fit.
- 35. varepsilon0** - ε_0
Initial photobleaching decay rate estimated from the control area.
- 36. bg0** - I_0^{BG}
Background intensity estimated directly from the background ROI (A.U.).
- 37. cs** - c_s
Stationary (pre-bleach) concentration level (A.U.).
- 38. covM**
Covariance matrix used to store all estimated errors.